

dubbed C++0x, is currently being developed.

1973: Ethernet

May: Metcalfe and His Ethernet

The widely-used networking protocol for local area networks—Ethernet—was created by Robert Metcalfe and others at Xerox PARC. It was originally known as Alto Aloha Network. It was standardised as IEEE 802.3. The term “Ethernet” was derived from the physical concept of the ether. This became a popular way of connecting computers to enable data sharing and to access devices such as printers.

Ethernet has different derivations; the original was designed as 10base5—10 stands for 10 MBps, Base is the baseband communication used, and 5 stands for 500 metres, the maximum distance of communication between the machines. Fast Ethernet or 100BASE-T gives transmission speeds of 100 MBps. Gigabit Ethernet is a newer version, which provides speeds of 10 to 100 Gigabits per second.

Spell It Out

The first display of alphanumeric information on an ordinary TV set was achieved through a TV typewriter designed by Don Lancaster in 1973. The two memory boards in the original model were capable of generating and storing 512 characters as 16 lines containing 32 characters. About 100 pages of text could be stored in a 90 minute tape if used for storage.

Hello!

Dr Martin Cooper made the first ever cell phone call using a Motorola Dyna-Tac at Motorola in 1973. He is known as the father of the cell phone.

1974: Computers Get Ahead

April: The 8080

Intel released the 8080, an 8-bit microprocessor, the successor to the 8008. It ran at 2 MHz, and processed 6,40,000 instructions per second. It was designed by Federico Faggin and Masatoshi Shima